



STRATHMORE UNIVERSITY
FACULTY OF COMMERCE

BACHELOR OF COMMERCE

END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATION

HED 2101: PRINCIPLES OF ETHICS

Groups B and C

DATE: March 2010

TIME: 2 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS

Answer ALL the questions

The exam will be marked over 75 and is worth 60% of final grade for the unit

Question 1 (10 marks):

- a) Explain the nature of Principles of Ethics (4 marks).
- b) Assess the relevance of what you have studied in Principles of Ethics for real life situations, including your current academic studies and future professional activity among others (6 marks).

Question 2 (20 marks):

- a) Explain the meaning of the term “moral virtue” (4 marks).
- b) What is “the good life” according to Aristotle? (4 marks).

- c) Indicate the virtue you have been trying to develop during the semester (2 marks).
- d) Explain how it relates to **five** of the topics covered in Principles of Ethics, excluding the topics directly related to the virtues [see the list of topics below to guide your choice] (10 marks).

[Topics covered: nature of Ethics; moral experience; relevance of Ethics; human person; freedom; happiness; self-determination; voluntary acts; Natural Moral Law; right reason; conscience; moral principles; legal norms; moral norms; evaluation of the morality of simple and complex actions]

Question 3 (22 marks):

When you reach school one Friday morning, you hear that your friends are planning to go to watch a new movie that evening which has just started showing in town. You know that the movie is pornographic and you don't agree with watching such movies. At the same time, you want to have fun with your friends and avoid being jeered at by them if you refuse to go. You spend the day in a dilemma about what to do and yet, you have to make a decision before school finishes for the day, as the plot will begin then.

- a) Identify the object, end and circumstances which you need to deal with to make your decision (6 marks).
- b) Assess the moral value of the object, end and circumstances in terms of the Natural Moral Law and / or moral virtues and the good life (6 marks).
- c) Decide which is the best way to act in moral terms (2 marks).
- d) Justify your decision by explaining the overall moral value of going to the movie and the overall moral value of not going to the movie (8 marks).

Question 4 (23 marks):

You are doing your industrial attachment in a medium sized private company where there is a lot of competition to advance and grow professionally. You like the challenging environment and hope to perform well during the attachment to increase your chances of being employed by the firm when you finish your degree.

During tea break one morning, some of the people in your department ask you to help them set up a situation in which their immediate supervisor, a middle level manager, can be unjustly accused of corruption. They want to get him fired so that one of them can be appointed to his post, they then plan to implement a scheme for making illegal money on the side through the normal business transactions of the company. They even offer you a small percentage of this income if their plan works out.

You are tempted to help them for the sake of the possible extra income and to humour them, yet, you fear that if your role in the plot is discovered, you may jeopardize your chances of being employed by the company at a later date. Eventually you decide to cooperate with them, although you don't agree with what they are doing, because perhaps they will be involved in accepting or rejecting you for employment later on, due to their position in the firm. All they want you to do is to verbally support their unjust accusation of corruption regarding the middle manager.

- a) Discover the following:
 - a. Does your decision involve you in cooperation in evil? (1 mark).
 - b. If it does, what type of cooperation is involved and why? (2 marks).
- b) Apply the four conditions that may make cooperation in evil licit to this case i.e. state each condition and identify it in this case (8 marks).
- c) Assess whether or not each condition is met giving a reason for your answer (8 marks).
- d) On the basis of your analysis, evaluate whether your cooperation is morally justifiable or not, giving reasons for your answer (4 marks).